Introduction to AI

Tiny lesson for first-year university students with no technical background

Lesson draft (under 150 words)

Artificial intelligence (AI) is technology that enables computers to perform tasks that usually require human intelligence, such as understanding language, recognizing images, or making decisions.

Machine learning (ML) is a type of AI that allows computers to learn patterns from examples and use them to make predictions or decisions, rather than following only explicitly programmed rules.

How are they related? AI is the broader field, while machine learning is one approach used to develop AI systems. Not all AI uses machine learning.

Example: Email spam filter. A spam filter can learn from emails labeled as “spam” or “not spam.” It identifies patterns, such as suspicious links or repeated advertising phrases, to classify new emails automatically. However, it might mistakenly classify an important email as spam or allow a harmful message into the inbox. This shows that AI can make mistakes and requires evaluation.

Educational sources

1. **IBM — What Is Artificial Intelligence (AI)?**
   Explains AI, machine learning, and how they relate.
   https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/artificial-intelligence

2. **IBM — What Is Machine Learning?**
   Explains how machine learning works and its relationship to AI.
   https://www.ibm.com/think/topics/machine-learning

Verification note: *The links were provided as educational sources in the draft. Check that the pages remain accessible and current before using this lesson.*